

1 CSS Implementation

No matter how well designed and well written the CSS code might be, it is of no use on its own. The CSS styles have to be applied to a clearly structured HTML web page. It is important to understand how the implementation of CSS works. Let's look at the different ways of applying CSS and their benefits and drawbacks.

1.1 The Basic HTML template

For all the examples in this chapter we will be using a simple HTML template having some standard document sections. Keep in mind that we are moving ahead with the assumption that you have some elementary understanding of HTML code.

To really understand and comprehend CSS, it's recommended that you copy the code from this template verbatim and try out all the examples yourself.

```
<!DOCTYPE html PUBLIC "-//W3C//DTD XHTML 1.0 Strict//
EN"
"http://www.w3.org/TR/xhtml1/DTD/xhtml1-strict.dtd">
<html>
<head>
  <title>CSS Implementation</title>
</head>
<body>
  <h1> CSS Implementation </h1>
  <p>This is a test website containing several HTML
  templates, each being styled using a different method
  of CSS application.</p>
  <p>Click an example below.</p>
  <h2>Examples</h2>
  <ul>
    <li><a href="base.html">Base template</a></li>
    <li><a href="inline.html">Inline CSS</a></li>
    <li><a href="embedded.html">Embedded CSS</a></li>
    <li><a href="external.html">External CSS</a></li>
    <li><a href="imported.html">Imported CSS</a></li>
  </ul>
```